

If you feel the screen size of a plasma display or a rear-projection television doesn't justify the price tag, the best answer is a projector

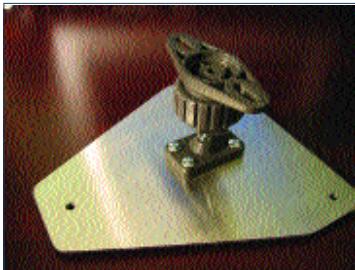
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Home theatres are all the rage now, as prices of the plasma displays and sound systems have dropped to affordable levels. But if you feel the screen size of a plasma display or a rear-projection television doesn't justify the price tag, what alternative do you have?

The best answer is a projector. Projectors are compact compared to rear-projection televisions or plasma displays, and the screen hangs on a wall—hence not occupying any floor space.

The only problem is the position of the projector: it has to be in front of the screen. This will leave you with the option of either sitting behind the projector or beside it.

Sitting behind the projector can be troublesome because of the noise of the fan and the bright light from the lamp.



A typical ceiling mount attachment

You can free the table space and reduce cable clutter by fixing the projector on the ceiling.

This will eliminate the problems that you might have faced, had the projector been



A projector with ceiling attachment

placed on the centre table or in a bookshelf. Also, mounting the projector on the ceiling will help in better air flow, but this will depend on the design of the mount as well.

A bad design might block the air flow and damage the components or reduce the lamp life, and lamps are expensive.

A ceiling mount for a projector is also useful in boardrooms where you need to have a fixed projector for presentations. Here, we help you to perform the mounting task all by yourself.



At present, there are no specific standards on adhering to dimensions for the ceiling mount.

You will have to get one that will work with your projector.

The right place to enquire for your model-specific ceiling mount is, of course, the vendor from whom you purchased the unit. Since ceiling mounts are not readily available, there may be a waiting period before you can get one.



The ceiling mount is not a single unit. In most cases, it is either in two (or a maximum of three) pieces—two plates and an arm.

The first plate with the drilled hole will exactly match the four drilled and taped holes at the bottom of the projector.

If the mount is brand and model-specific, be rest assured—you will get a smooth fit.

If you get a universal ceiling mount, you will need to adjust the plate to match the mount holes at the back

of the projector. There are several designs available, for example, a single plate with many drilled holes so that it can match a wide variety of projector models.

Alternatively, use four flexible arms instead of a plate, so that you can move it to the position exactly over the mount holes on the projector and fix it.

Fix another plate on the ceiling securely, as this plate is the one that will bear the weight of the projector and the mounting arm.



Fix one side of the flexible arm first to the ceiling plate, and then

►► Buying Tips

Some considerations to bear in mind when selecting a projector

LCD vs DLP

❑ Differences are minimal for most educational uses

❑ Better contrast ratios of DLP may be better suited for high ambient light situations

Image features

❑ Check the brightness first and then the contrast ratio

❑ Match the resolution of projector to that of the computer

❑ Consider short throw distance and keystone correction as extra features

Connectivity

❑ Wireless connectivity is the latest new feature in projectors

❑ Wireless is useful for rapidly switching between multiple inputs

Size

❑ While smaller projectors provide flexibility, it is at the cost of some advanced features and physical security

Educational features

❑ Blackboard mode helps compensate when projecting without a screen

❑ Bundled document cameras can project paper and 3-D objects

❑ Copy-boards can be used for annotating and saving images

